CASE STUDY · 2016

BrightTV Subscription Growth & Consumption Insights

A data-led analysis of 5,375 South African viewers and 10,000 sessions

Bright TV

Data · Insights · Growth

PREPARED BY · TENDAI SHUMBA

tendai.activetutors@gmail.com · github.com/tendaiactivetutors-beep

CONTENTS

What we will cover

A data-led journey from raw signals to growth strategy

01 **Dataset Overview**
5,375 users · 10,000 sessions · 21 channels

02 **Audience Profile**
Demographics, geography, age

03 **Content Performance**
Channels & categories that drive watch time

04 **When People Watch**
Hour-of-day & day-of-week patterns

05 **The Sports Effect**
Why March 2016 broke records

06 **Engagement Heatmap**
Day × hour intensity map

07 **Underserved Segments**
Who is missing from the platform

08 **Growth Recommendations**
Content · Scheduling · Marketing · Product

OBJECTIVE

Why this analysis matters?

BrightTV needs evidence-based answers to grow subscribers and watch time

THE QUESTION

How can BrightTV convert more casual viewers into loyal subscribers?

We answer this by mining session-level viewing data, layering it with user demographics, and surfacing the moments where engagement peaks — and where it leaks.

UNDERSTAND

Behaviour patterns at the session level

IDENTIFY

Peak windows, by day & hour

QUANTIFY

The role of sports in driving engagement

RECOMMEND

Specific actions for content & growth teams

DATASET

What we are working with

User profiles + viewership log · 2016-01-01 to 2016-03-31

5,375	10,000	1,498	21
USERS	**SESSIONS**	**HOURS**	**CHANNELS**
unique profiles	*viewing records*	*total watch time*	*across 6 categories*

WHAT THE DATA TELLS US

- Average session length: 9.4 minutes
- Top channel: ICC Cricket World Cup 2011 — 412 hours watched
- Sports content: 54.8% of all watch time
- Most active day: Saturday · least active: Monday
- Median viewer age: 32 years

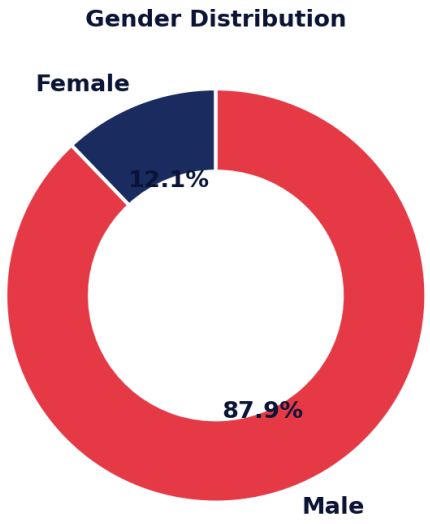
⚠ DATA QUALITY NOTES

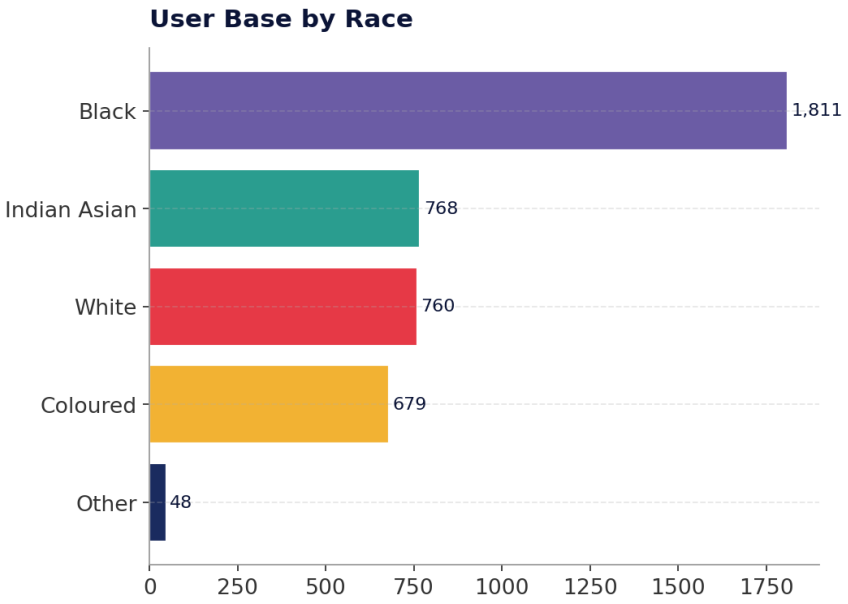
- Original brief said Jan–Apr; data ends 31 Mar 2016
- ~4% of sessions (262) have no matching profile
- Gender field missing for 4% of users; race for 4%
- Heavy male skew (76.0%) suggests sampling bias

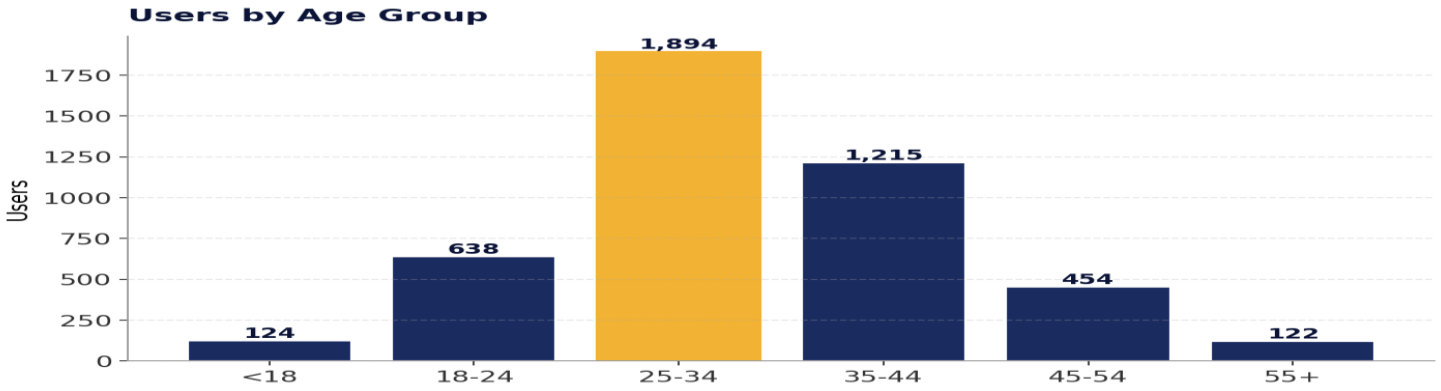
AUDIENCE

Who is watching BrightTV

A male-skewed, urban, working-age viewer base







KEY TAKEAWAYS

87.9%

of stated profiles are male — a major imbalance vs. SA (~49%)

33.0%

of users live in Gauteng — concentration risk

32

is the median age — squarely working-age adults

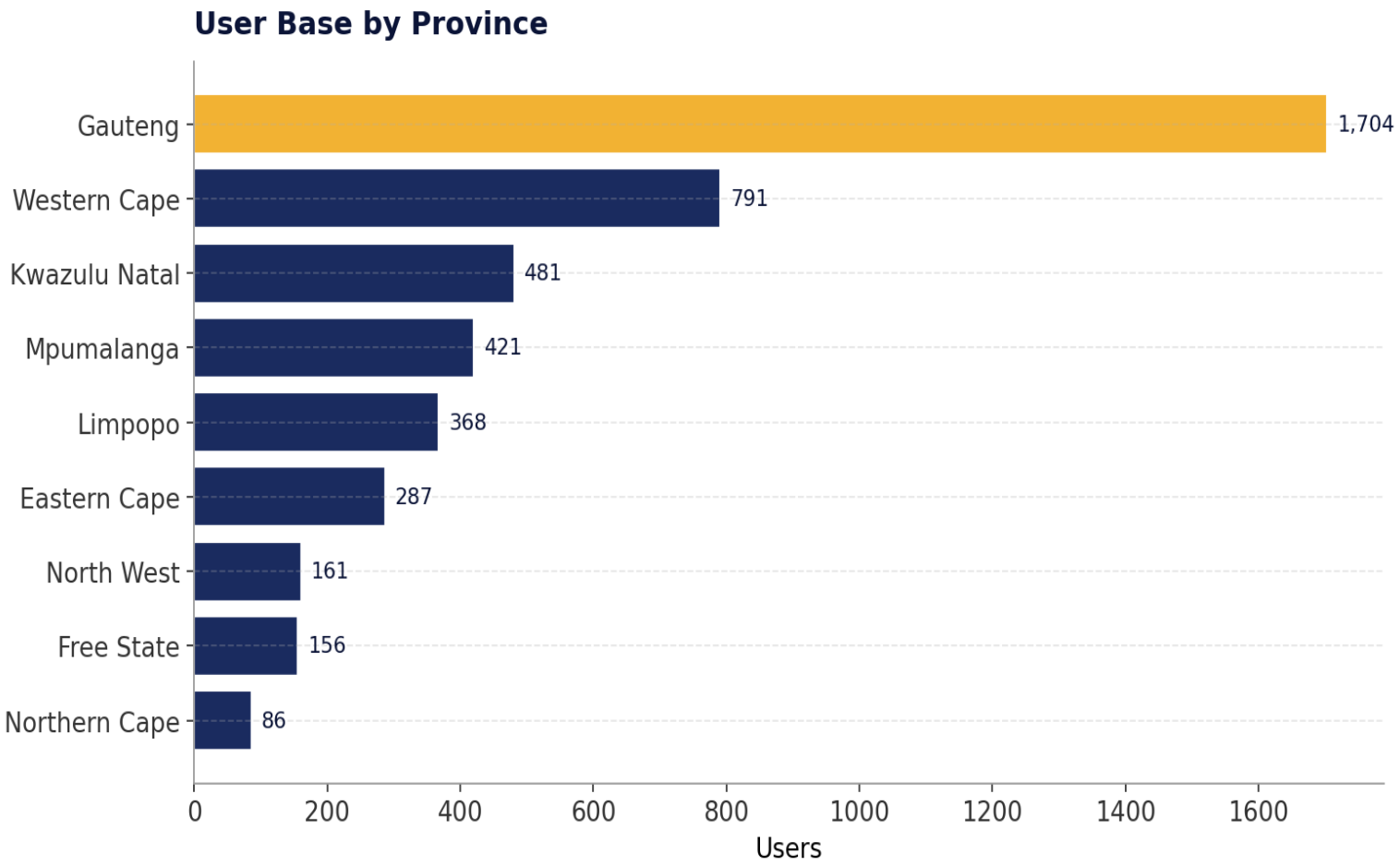
Black

is the largest race group — Trace TV & Channel O resonate

GEOGRAPHY

Where the audience lives

Gauteng dominates — but creates a single-province dependency risk



CONCENTRATION RISK

33.0%

of all users in Gauteng alone. Western Cape (15%) and KZN (9%) are next.

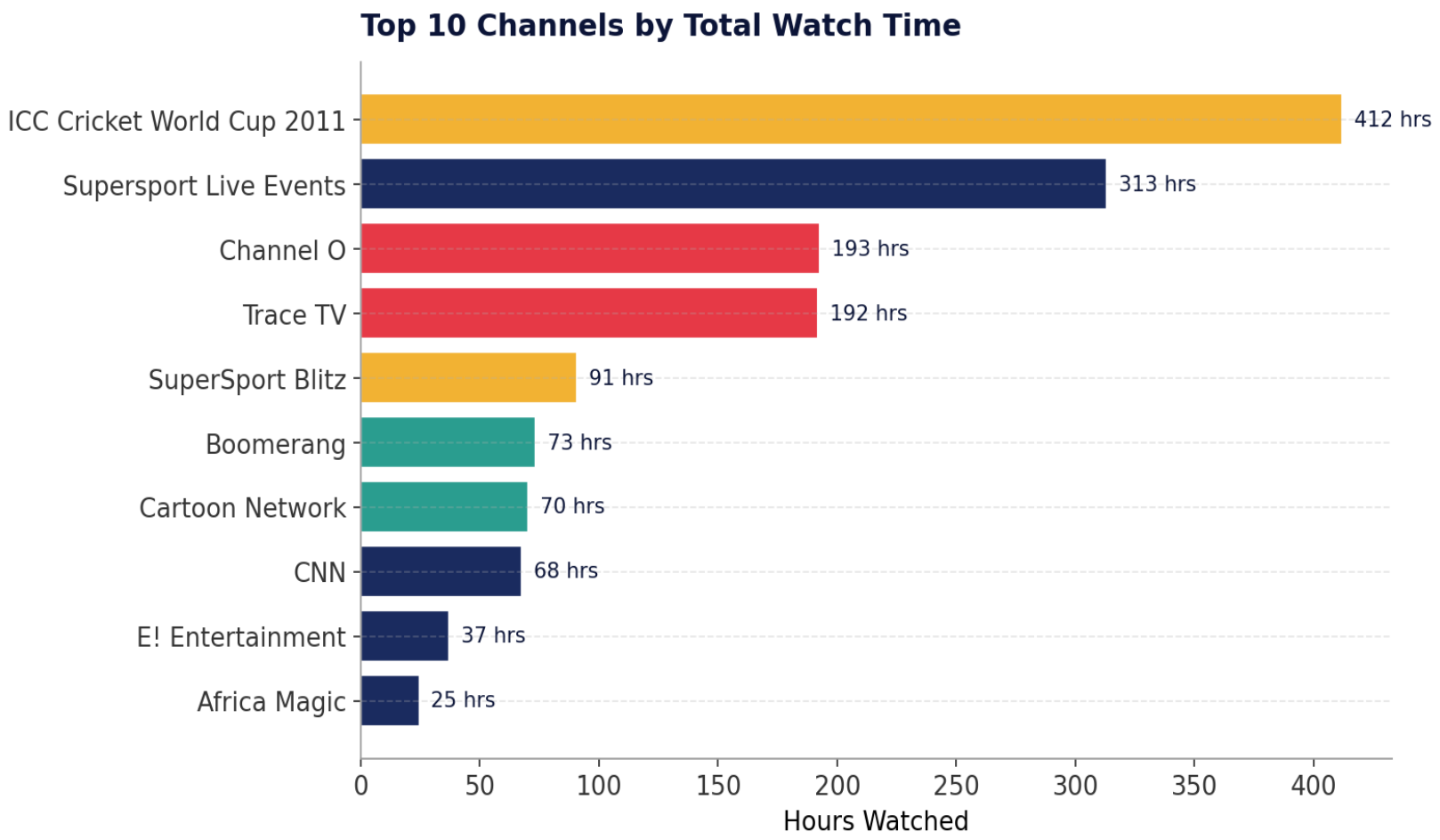
OPPORTUNITY

- Geo-targeted campaigns in KZN, Eastern Cape, Limpopo
- Localised content partnerships per region
- Data-sponsored offers for low-income provinces

CONTENT

Top channels by watch time

Two sports properties capture more than 40% of all viewing hours



#1 CHANNEL

ICC Cricket World Cup

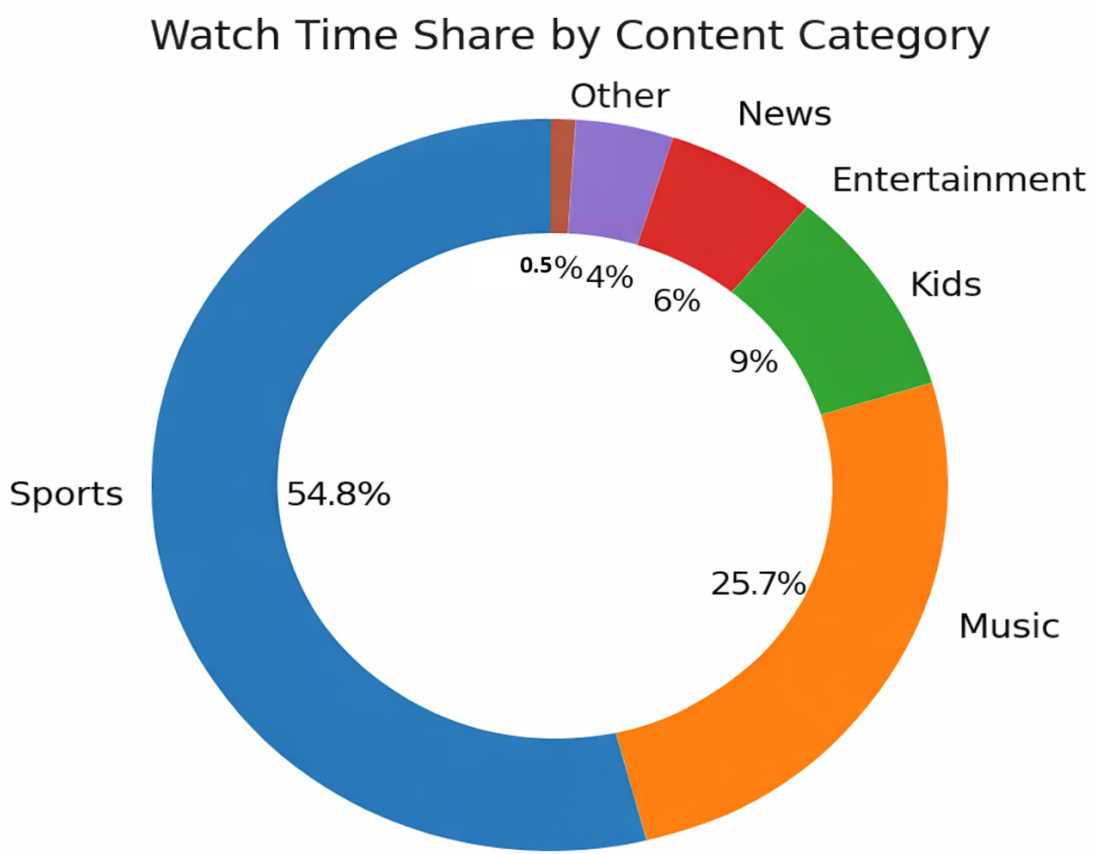
412 hrs

watched in 3 months

Live, time-bound, must-watch — the perfect engagement engine.

Category share of watch time

Sports + Music = 80% of all hours. Everything else competes for the remaining fifth.



SPORTS

54.8%

Live cricket + SuperSport drive the platform

MUSIC

25.7%

Trace TV & Channel O — youth-focused

KIDS

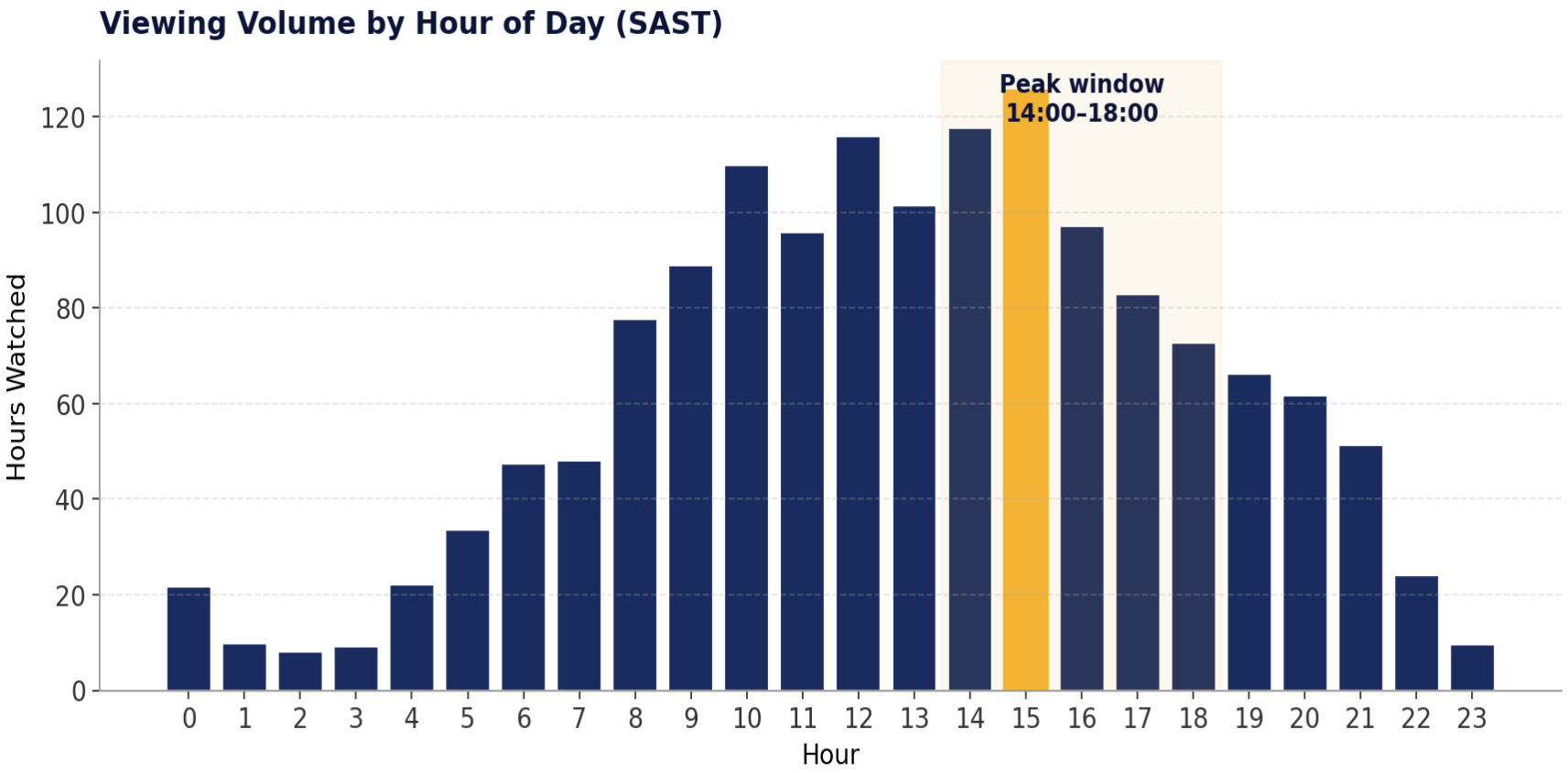
9%

Boomerang & Cartoon Network — steady

TIMING

Viewing volume by hour of day

Engagement peaks at 15:00 — the late-afternoon sports window



PEAK HOUR

15:00

125 hrs that hour

WINDOW

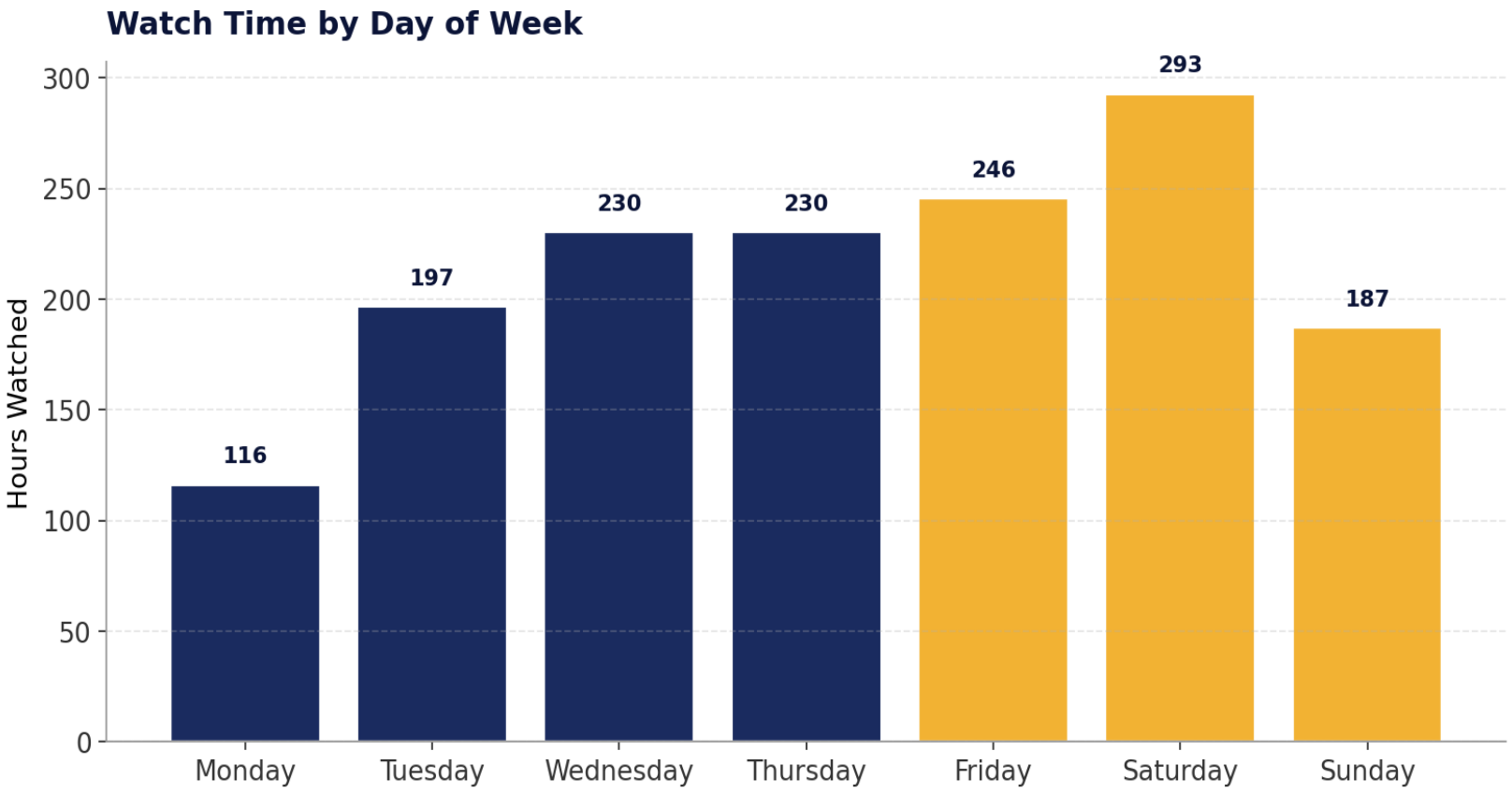
14:00 – 18:00
the high-intent afternoon block

ACTION · Schedule premieres, push notifications, and ad inventory between 14:00 and 18:00 SAST.

WEEKLY RHYTHM

Watch time by day of week

Saturday is 2.5× bigger than Monday



BIGGEST DAY

Saturday

293 hours watched

WEAKEST DAY

Monday

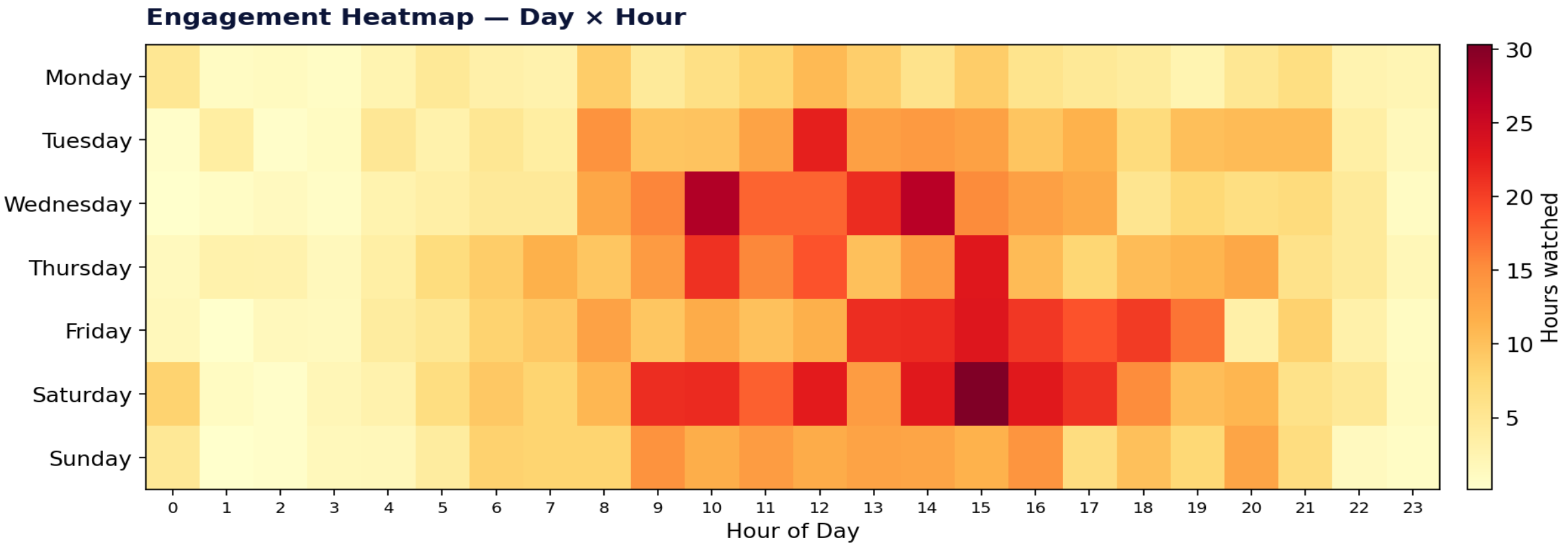
only 116 hours — fix the slump

ACTION · Run "Monday Night" exclusives or live-discussion shows to lift the weekly low.

HEATMAP

When the audience is really watching

Saturday & Sunday afternoons own the platform



WEEKEND AFTERNOONS

Densest activity zone — premium ad slots

WEEKDAY MORNINGS

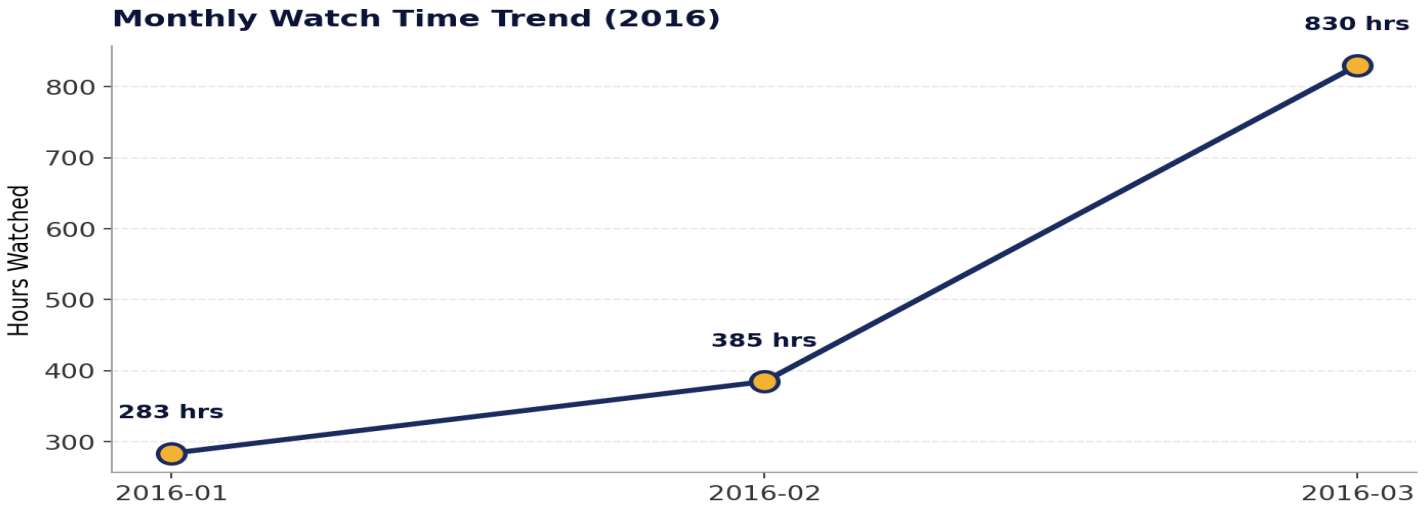
Largely empty — ideal for catch-up content

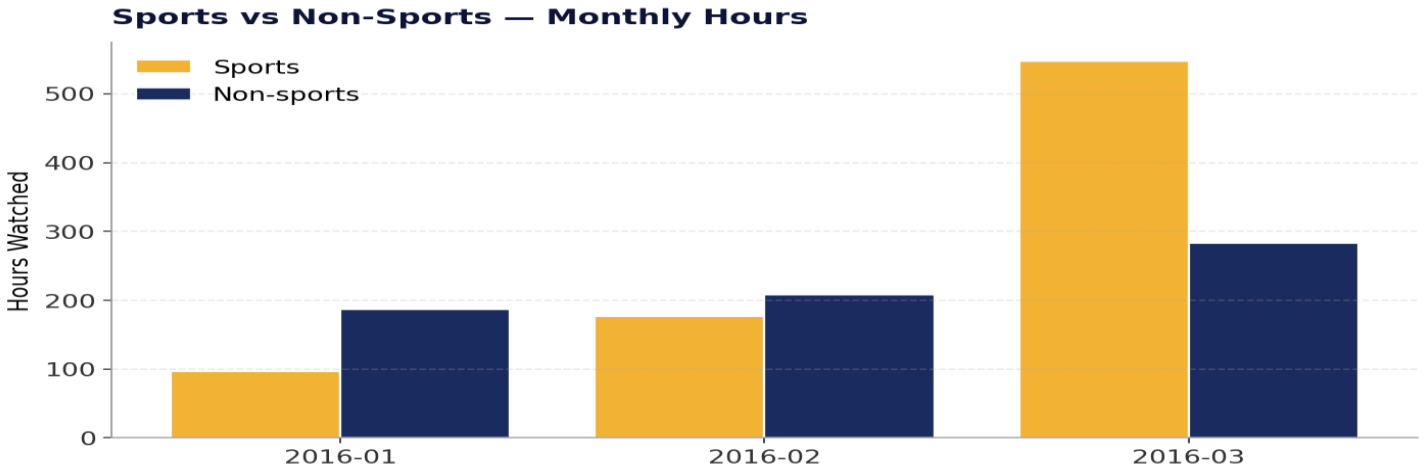
LATE NIGHTS (23-04)

Near-zero — do not invest premium spend here

Why March 2016 broke records

Watch time grew 192.9% from January to March — driven by the Cricket World Cup





THE INSIGHT

+192.9%

growth in monthly hours
from Jan to Mar 2016

WHAT DROVE IT

- ICC Cricket World Cup live coverage
- SuperSport Live Events momentum
- Weekend match scheduling
- A loyal, engaged sports audience

GAPS

Who is missing from the platform

Three audience gaps represent BrightTV's biggest growth levers

GAP 01

Female viewers

only 12.1%

vs. ~51% of SA population. A 5pt lift = +270 users from existing base alone.

Lifestyle, drama, reality blocks

GAP 02

Under-18 audience

~14%

Kids content is stable but small. Strong opportunity in family bundles.

Family pricing & parental controls

GAP 03

Provinces beyond Gauteng

67% non-Gauteng

Nine provinces, but content & marketing skews urban-Gauteng.

Localised content + data offers

RECOMMENDATIONS

Eight moves to grow BrightTV

Grouped into Content · Scheduling · Marketing · Product

CONTENT

1. Double down on live sports licensing
2. Commission female-led drama & lifestyle

SCHEDULING

1. Premiere new shows 14:00–18:00
2. Launch a "Monday Night Live" anchor block

MARKETING

1. Sync paid campaigns with sports calendar
2. Geo-target 8 provinces beyond Gauteng

PRODUCT

1. Free trials triggered by major matches
2. Smart re-engagement push for inactive users

ROADMAP

90-day growth playbook

Sequenced bets, from quick wins to platform-level changes

DAYS 1–30

QUICK WINS

- Reschedule premieres to 14–18h
- Push notifications for live matches
- A/B test "Monday Live" block

DAYS 31–60

BUILD

- Female-audience content pilot
- Geo-targeted ad creative for 3 provinces
- Free 7-day trial post-trial offers

DAYS 61–90

SCALE

- Sports calendar–synced campaigns
- Personalised home screen
- Family bundle launch

CONCLUSION

What we learned · what to do next

Five truths from the data — and the actions that follow

1. **SPORTS IS KING**

   54.8% of all hours come from sports. Cricket alone delivered 412 hrs in Q1.

   → **License live, market live**

2. **TIME IS MONEY**

   15:00 is the absolute peak; 14–18h is the high-intent window.

   → **Schedule and price by daypart**

3. **SATURDAY SAVES**

   Saturday is 2.5× Monday. Weekly rhythm is extreme.

   → **Build weekday anchor shows**

4. **MARCH MULTIPLIES**

   +192.9% month-on-month growth proves event-driven demand.

   → **Sync the marketing calendar**

5. **WE ARE UNBALANCED**

   87.9% male, 33.0% Gauteng. Growth lives in the gaps.

   → **Invest in women, youth & regions**

Thank you.

Questions, ideas, and next steps welcome.

PREPARED BY

Tendai Shumba

tendai.activetutors@gmail.com

github.com/tendaiactivetutors-beep